

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	One-variable data: Distributions and measures of center and spread	Medium

Question

4, 10, 18, 4, 4, 5, 6, 5

What is the median of the data set shown?

Answer

- A. 4
- B. 5
- C. 7
- D. 14

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. If a data set contains an even number of data values, when the data values are listed in ascending or descending order, the median is between the two middle values. The given data set contains 8 values. When listed in ascending order, the data set is 4, 4, 4, 5, 5, 6, 10, 18 and the two middle values are 5 and 5. Since the two middle values are the same, the median must be 5.

Choice A is incorrect. This value is between the two middle values in the list shown, not the two middle values when the data values are listed in ascending or descending order.

Choice C is incorrect. This is the mean, not the median, of the data set.

Choice D is incorrect. This is the range, not the median, of the data set.